MIL-F-36060C
13 August 1971
SUPERSEDING
MIL-F-36060B
31 August 1970

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FORCEPS, UTERINE, CURVED, SKENE

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers curved uterine forceps of the Skene design used in gynecological procedures.

1.2 Classification. The uterine forceps shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1).

Type I. Tenaculum.
Type II. Vulsellum.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

GG-I-526	Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.
MMM-A-250	Adhesive, Water-Resistant, (For Sealing Fiberboard Boxes).
PPP-B-585	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.

FSC 6515

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SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-76	Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive Paper, (For Carton Sealing).

Military

MIL-P-116	Preservation, Methods of

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWINGS

Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC)

20367	Forceps, Uterine, Curved, Skene, 9-1/2 inch (Tenaculum).
20442	Forceps, Uterine, Curved Sideways, Skene, 10 inch (Vulsellum)

(Copies of specifications, standards, and drawings required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General Requirements. The two types of uterine forceps, of the Skene design, shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of GG-I-526 and as specified herein.

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3.2 Material. The uterine forceps shall be fabricated from Class 4, Type 420 or 420F material.

3.3 Hardness. After proper stress relieving, the uterine forceps shall have a Rockwell hardness of C40 to C45.

3.4 Style, design and dimensions. The uterine forceps, shall be of the Skene design, suitable for use in gynecological surgical procedures.

* 3.4.1 Type I forceps (Tenaculum). Type I forceps shall be of the Skene design, having blades curved sideways. Forceps shall have sharp, tenaculum type working jaws (points). The working jaws shall be flush to each other, as indicated on drawing, when the forceps are placed in the closed position. The points shall not butt against each other, when tested as specified in 4.4.1. Points shall be ground sharp and be free from burrs, nicks, cracks and dents. The ends of the jaws shall not protrude outward from the shanks, when the forceps are placed in the closed position. Type I forceps shall have box-lock construction for style A design, and shall be of the screw type for style B design. Forceps of style B design shall have a stop pin integral to one of the shanks. Forceps shall be in strict accordance with DPSC Drawing 20367 for appropriate type, stock number and item identification.

* 3.4.2 Type II forceps (Vulsellum). Type II forceps shall be of the Skene design, having blades curved sideways, and 2 by 2 vulsella type teeth. Forceps shall be suitable for seizing or lifting tumor or uterus during gynecological surgical procedures. The working jaws (points) shall be flush to each other, as indicated on drawing, when the forceps are placed in the closed position. The points shall not butt against each other when tested as specified in 4.4.1. Points shall be ground sharp, and be free from burrs, nicks, cracks and dents. The ends of the jaws shall not protrude outward from the shanks, when the forceps are placed in the closed position. Type II forceps shall be of the screw type or box-lock design. When forceps are of the screw type design, a stop pin shall be integral to one of the shanks. Forceps shall be in strict accordance with DPSC Drawing 20442 for appropriate type, stock number and item identification.

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3.5 Finish. Finish shall be mirror.

3.6 Flushness of jaws. When tested as specified in 4.4.2, the working jaws shall not allow full passage of the test material.

3.7 Shank side play. When tested as specified in 4.4.3, the working jaws shall not reverse orientation (position) with respect to each other.

3.8 Locks. Forceps of box-lock construction shall have shanks tested for lock stiffness in accordance with GG-I-526.

3.9 Identification marking. In addition to GG-I-526 requirements, forceps of foreign manufacture shall also be marked "stainless".

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection. Shall be in accordance with GG-I-526.

4.1.2 Records. Records of examination and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the corrosion resisting steel may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the government. The certificates shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the FSN, the item identification, the name of the material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, the individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one forceps.

Table I. Sampling Criteria for Examination

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent (defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	2.5

* 4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in Table II. Unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps.

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Table II. Sampling Criteria for Tests

Component	Characteristic	Reqt.	Test procedure	Insp. level	AQL
	Composition analysis	3.2 and GG-I-526	GG-I-526	*	1.0
Forceps	Hardness	3.3 and GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0
	Dimensions	3.4.1 and 3.4.2	----	S-2	4.0
	Copper sulfate test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0
	Boil test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0
	Butting test (points)	3.4.1 and 3.4.2	4.4.1	S-2	1.0
	Flushness test (points)	3.6	4.4.2	S-2	1.0
	Shank side play test	3.7	4.4.3	S-2	1.0
	Box-lock test (when applicable)	3.8	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0

* Four ounces of each lot of metal used in the construction of the forceps shall be selected for chemical analysis.

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*

4.3 Examination. The forceps shall be examined to determine compliance with all the requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in Tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in Table III. Any forceps in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected, and if the number of defective items in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for test sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

Table III. Classification of Defects

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Forceps not of the proper type.
102	Forceps not free from cracks, pits, dents, nicks, or burrs.
103	Working points not sharp.
104	Working points protrude outward (away from shanks) in the closed position.
105	Points set below each other.
106	Finish not mirror, or not uniform.
107	Ratchet teeth not uniform, or function poorly.
108	Type I or Type II forceps of screw design, does not contain stop pin.
109	Forceps exhibits excessive play in box-lock area or screw fastening area.
Minor	
201	Identification marking not present, correct, complete or legible.

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4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Butting test. The forceps shall be placed in the open position. The forceps shall then be gradually closed in the normal manner. This test shall be performed 5 times. The action of the working points for butting shall be noted.

4.4.2 Flushness test. The forceps shall be placed in the closed position. A metal thickness gage (feeler gage) not exceeding 0.002 inch shall be used to determine if gaps between both sides of each jaw allow full passage of the feeler gage. The feeler gage shall notbe forced between the jaws, but utilized with as little force possible.

4.4.3 Shank side play. The forceps shall be opened and closed (exerting normal pressure at the ratchet end) for a total of 10 times to determine if the jaws reverse position with respect to each other during this test.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in Table IV shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table IV. Packaging Quantities

Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1 unit	6 units	144 units

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5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Cleaning and drying. Each unit shall be thoroughly cleaned and dried in accordance with the applicable method as outlined in MIL-P-116.

5.1.3.2 Preservative. Not required.

5.1.3.3 Intimate wrap. Each unit shall be wrapped in neutral tissue or other suitable anticorrosive material.

5.1.3.4 Unit package. Each unit shall be packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method 1A-8.

5.1.3.5 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be a box of appropriate size and design constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather-resistant. Boxes shall be closed by taping the top and bottom flaps with 2-inch wide tape conforming to PPP-T-76. Closing of bottom flaps with adhesive conforming to MMM-A-250 or metal stitches is permitted.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

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5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, constructed so as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. These forceps, of the Skene design, are to be used in gynecological surgical procedures.

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Number, title and date of this specification.
(b) Type (see 1.2).
(c) Applicable Federal Stock Number (FSN).
(d) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 6.1 and 5.2).

* 6.3 This specification covers the items listed in the Federal Supply Catalog and as indicated below. If does not include all types as indicated by the titles nor all types commercially available.

Federal Stock Number	Item Identification
6515-337-6400	FORCEPS, UTERINE, Curved, Skene, 9-1/2 inch, (Tenaculum).
6515-338-7600	FORCEPS, UTERINE, Curved, Sideways, Skene, 10 inch (Vulsellum).

6.4 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:
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Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activities:
Army - MD
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Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
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3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
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5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

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7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
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